CAMPAIGNER GUIDE TO
PERSONAL GROWTH

Get the most out of life, become all you hope to be, and explore your potential

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Personal Growth Matters to Campaigners

Campaigners possess a strong zest for living. They want to get the most that they can out of it. This e-book can guide them toward deeper self-understanding as an essential part of striving to be all that they hope to be. Throughout this book, we discuss what Campaigners' combined traits reveal about their unique personality type. We examine their behaviors and focus on their influence on personal growth, which is a critical endeavor for a personality type possessed of such passionate ideas and drive.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Campaigners exude a positivity that affirms their faith in humanity. Though they might not linger long on any singular cause, the need to help others strongly motivates them. Like all Diplomats, Campaigners carry a sense of mission that usually involves making the world a better place by helping people explore their potential for growth. Campaigners grow most when they feel that they've been instrumental in helping others grow.

Their gifts for spontaneity and novel approaches can produce fresh directions. However, they can also distract people with this personality type and cause them to lose focus. Campaigners sometimes overlook mundane but important things in life. For these types, growing may mean keeping their unique perspectives alive while also learning to discipline themselves and commit to a single direction. When

Campaigners connect such focus to doing good for other people, they're likely to take it more seriously.

Self-Understanding and Expression

It's vital for these outgoing personalities to connect with people. Campaigners are imaginative, occasionally to the point of quirkiness. Their personal development may include reconciling these two opposing characteristics by becoming part of a crowd of people from whom they may be different. Learning to express themselves genuinely, despite the valued opinions of people they respect, can be their key to personal growth. Campaigners may eventually learn that winning favor by pretending to be someone they're not doesn't work for them. Those who come to this understanding recognize that authenticity is worth the risk.

Self-understanding helps Campaigners achieve a fulfilling balance between expressing themselves and relating to their environment in healthy ways. When Campaigners understand their own inner workings and responses, it becomes easier for them to explore life's possibilities – and their own potential. Personal growth is an exciting journey, and even overcoming one's own personality challenges can be enjoyable with the right perspective. Campaigners often focus on fostering what they see as necessary progress in the world around them, but perhaps even more important is the progress that they make within themselves.

Facets of Personal Growth

Campaigners try to balance their bodies and minds as well as their emotions and intellect. This is what personal growth means to them. But, that said, they are likely to grow mostly through the filter of emotions – the balance that they strive for helps them show their concern for others more holistically. With self-improvement as a vital part of their lives, they're likely to use their typical emotions and compassion to discover and build their strengths.

Personal growth almost defines what it means to be a Campaigner. So, it's easy to see how they might have qualities built into their personalities that foster the ongoing task of development. A list of these might include:

- **Growth as a Main Drive.** A desire to be better is the primary fuel that drives Campaigners. Personal development, in some form, is often on their minds.
- **The Right Tools.** Combining emotional energy and intuitive insight helps Campaigners discover and pursue their unique paths to growth.
- **Proper Alignment.** Campaigners' values and communities are important to them and offer a structure for their growth. When they align themselves with either or both, as they have a tendency to, they are likely heading toward their best selves.

However, that's not to say that these growth-driven individuals have no challenges with personal development. In that regard, Campaigners aren't different from any other type. Often, such challenges result from strengths being overblown and out of balance. A few examples of the problems that Campaigners might face with personal growth include:

- **Oversensitivity.** The emotions that aid Campaigners' growth can bring them to the point of near-constant stress if difficult feelings become too common. This can threaten their confidence and rob them of enthusiasm. The lack of confidence can prevent them from exploring new things.
- **Unfocused Approach.** These types are likely to have a constant flood of ideas and feelings. Without an effort to focus on clear goals, they can become lost in too many options.

- **Unrealistic Expectations.** Campaigners may expect too much of themselves and others. This can lead to an ongoing sense of frustration, and perhaps over time, discourage them from pursuing challenging goals.

But challenges aside, personal growth is the adventure that gives Campaigners much of the meaning in their lives. And what's an adventure without a few tests to keep things interesting? Campaigners who focus their vision and lead with their emotions in a balanced way are likely to make the greatest gains with personal development.

What Makes Campaigners Tick

Five closely related parts of the Campaigner personality motivate them to seek growth. Three involve how Campaigners think of themselves – called the Reflective Qualities. These give the fuel that launches personal growth attempts and include self-esteem, self-respect, and self-confidence. Two involve more action-oriented qualities that can help them achieve the first three – called the Developmental Qualities. These include self-evolution and self-responsibility.

Reflective Qualities

- **Self-esteem** describes how much Campaigners like themselves. They're most pleased with themselves when they act out of empathy to help others.
- **Self-respect** speaks to Campaigners' sense of worth. They find their value when they act with compassion toward the people in their lives.
- **Self-confidence** is the energy source that moves Campaigners forward in life. When they sense that they're connected to their values and their ideals, they're likely to pass their days with confidence.

Developmental Qualities

- **Self-evolution** involves the methods that Campaigners use to grow. These are the tactics that help them fulfill their self-esteem, self-respect, and self-confidence needs.

- **Self-responsibility** involves how much Campaigners take charge of their own lives and are answerable for their decisions. They cannot rely on others for their personal growth.

How These Qualities Work

Understanding personal growth is about understanding one's motivations and the needs that a person can only meet for themselves – thus all the "self-" terms. These concepts give us a model for thinking about personal growth, and they allow us to explore self-development in a structured way.

Each of the three Reflective Qualities defines something needed for Campaigners to find fulfillment. Approval of oneself, a healthy sense of value, and self-assurance are typical goals to meet when working toward a happy life. And though they may not always realize why, they likely feel incomplete if positive versions of these qualities aren't part of who they are. If they address these, and Campaigners most likely do, they typically use the Developmental Qualities to do so.

If the elements that influence personal growth come to be lopsided, they can create great difficulty. Most often, this occurs because Campaigners don't apply traits fully enough or, on the other hand, overuse them and allow them to "overheat."

For example, Campaigners' self-confidence comes from sensing their connection to their values. But if they feel insecure, they may become more rigid in their beliefs to the point of trying to force them on other people. They may accept nothing less than perfection from others. This can twist their compassionate ideals into something that doesn't consider the feelings and thoughts of others. Instead, they could begin to practice the opposite of compassion.

So...

With these ideas in mind, we first examine Campaigners' characteristics in their ideal form. When it all comes together in healthy ways, they lead fulfilling, useful, and happy lives. The first part of each section – the "Balanced" section – highlights Campaigners' personality strengths at their best and shows what it may look like when it all works.

Next, we show what may happen when Campaigners overexpress or underexpress their typical characteristics. While the problems are not inevitable, we describe some that they may face when trying to meet their growth needs in the second part of each section – the "Unbalanced" section. Because of ineffective or insufficient expressions of their traits, they can get results far from those that they intended. This can leave them discouraged and puzzled.

Finally, we discuss how Campaigners can develop more well-rounded approaches to their characteristics. We provide positive tips and steps that they might take to further their personal growth. Restoring balance when needed is the goal in this "Rebalancing" section, and there are practical things to explore. We encourage you to try the suggestions.

Self-Esteem

Self-esteem is a way of describing how well Campaigners appreciate themselves. Do they see themselves positively, and is healthy self-love a primary component of their thinking process and daily mindset? Developing this quality helps give these personalities a strong internal foundation.

Balanced Self-Esteem

Campaigners like themselves when they do good for others, but their sense of self-esteem comes from more than doing simple good deeds. These types live in a world of ideas and theories sifted through their emotional decision-making. Their chosen paths are linked to values conceived through their Intuitive and Feeling traits.

The role of principles in Campaigner deeds are:

- **Driven by Ideology.** Campaigners contribute because of ideology more than the pull of a specific charity. They typically involve themselves with charities that fit their principles rather than build principles around charity involvement. They tend to be more proactive.

- **Built on Strong Foundations.** Although they may appear to be, Campaigners' empathic acts are rarely random or sentimental. But the underlying motivations come from their well-considered ideas of how life should be, and they have a clear concept of how they should help others. Their kindly deeds are usually not casual in a strict sense.

For Campaigners, helping a struggling friend by delivering much-needed groceries is more than feeding someone they care for. It's also a need to make the world a place where nobody goes without. When they feel they've dealt with that value, the ending of hunger, they are more likely to like themselves, and their self-esteem is likely to grow.

Motivated by Empathy

Campaigners' good works involve helping those they see in need, rather than seeking out social causes. That said, giving bread to the hungry isn't enough, either. Discovering why the poor can't access food for themselves is something Campaigners are likely to mull over – maybe even obsess about. But, in the end, their most active response directly addresses the problems they see.

Characteristics of their empathy include:

- **Big-Picture Empathy.** Campaigners try to uncover the core of social problems even as they take care of more practical matters. They are typically more interested in responding to people directly than with systems.
- **Grassroots Compassion.** These types are more likely to respond in daily life than to create or join a crusade, and they lead from their empathy more than from their sense of duty or an organized mission. Their self-esteem comes from lending a helping hand more than joining a movement.

Campaigners may have many strong opinions and ideas about the world, but that's not where their self-esteem is likely to come from. It comes, instead, from their sense of how they respond to other individuals.

Unbalanced Self-Esteem

Impossible Standards

Campaigners' idealism is deeply linked to their compassionate acts. When high expectations collide with reality, it can throw their sense of self into disorder if they aren't careful. Confusion about doing enough of the right thing is likely to muddy the waters around self-esteem.

Attitudes that hinder Campaigners' self-esteem include:

- **Need for Perfection.** "Perfect" is the Campaigners' ideal – and yet there's little in the world without flaws. When they inevitably miss impossibly perfect targets, they can feel like they haven't done all they could.
- **Self-Defeating Dreamers.** Campaigners are sensitive "people who need people." But everyday people may roll their eyes at the grand principles held by these dreamers. And, if this prevents them from connecting in meaningful and caring ways, their self-esteem suffers.

While principles are important, impossible standards won't lead to success. Campaigners who cannot balance their values with common sense are likely to have difficulty growing self-esteem. Without that balance, there is too much potential for a sense of failure and a lack of connection to others.

The Burden of Empathy

On the surface, being popular and empathic may seem enviable, but these traits can be a stressful burden when combined. Empathy extends beyond sympathy and just feeling sorry or happy for someone. It dives in and shares the sadness or joy experienced by others.

While on the surface empathy may sound noble, pitfalls often go with it, including:

- **Too Much Empathetic Investment.** Buying into one other person's hard times can be taxing. Take the number of people Campaigners typically know, add their caring natures, and the weight of empathy can become difficult to carry.

- **Unhelpful Sensitivity.** While Campaigners thrive on expressing their concern for others, the stress from too much of the negative things happening to others can badly influence their mood and behavior. This can potentially cause them to withdraw.

Empathy is a core part of Campaigners' character. It's a huge motivator that inspires them to do the things that build their self-esteem. However, like all good things, without moderating forces to keep things in balance, empathy becomes too much and brings them something other than the desired results.

Rebalancing Self-Esteem

Learning to Celebrate an Imperfect World

For Campaigners, sometimes setting perfectionism aside means getting out of one's head and back into the material world. Reality inevitably contains flaws that help provide perspective. Fortunately, these types may be the most observant among Diplomats. Their curiosity supports the use of their senses and connects them to the present moment.

Here is a list of suggestions that can help these types reconnect with the physical world when needed:

- Meditation, mindful eating, and yoga all bring the gift of the here and now by dealing with "what is" rather than "what should be." Try one of them.
- Playing a sport brings the gift of physicality and the reality of competition and challenges.
- Dancing is a physical action that connects beautifully to emotions.
- Gardening is a physical, creative act that can even contribute to better nutrition.

Experiencing the world through something one might touch or smell can rebalance Campaigners' drive for self-esteem. Grabbing hold of the gritty, concrete world restores balance. Embracing the reality found there can help Campaigners better meet their goals.

How to Accept What Cannot Be Changed

Once Campaigners learn that not every problem has a direct solution, it can lift an excessive burden from their shoulders. Not everybody can be saved. Not everyone wants to be saved. It's possible to care deeply about someone and still not be able to help them. Knowing this, these types can effectively do the things that their self-esteem demands. It doesn't have to include burning out and leaving themselves useless to others. They can perhaps express compassion even better when they prioritize.

Here is an exercise Campaigners can perform to begin thinking about realistic priorities:

- For this exercise, dedicate a trash basket and place it in a conspicuous place. Then, count out 12 index cards or small pieces of paper.
- On each card, write something that must be accepted about the plight of someone close – something that can't be changed. Take as much time as needed to come up with twelve. It need not be completed in one session.
- Then, scrunch the paper up and throw it in the wastebasket as a symbolic act.
- Don't assume this act will end empathetic feelings toward even those with problems that can't be helped. Those feelings will remain – but, hopefully, a more practical perspective will be gained.

Campaigners' primary impulse tends to be to always help anyone in need. That's unlikely to change. However, being wiser about where to put their efforts can make a difference in the quality of Campaigners' lives.

Self-Respect

Self-respect measures Campaigners' sense of their worth. What makes them think of themselves as valuable people? The answer to this question lies in the degree to which they do the good that their ideals suggest that they should.

Balanced Self-Respect

Building Connections and Seeking Purpose

When they combine their caring nature with their outgoing nature, Campaigners connecting with others is more than just "social." These connections lead to:

- **Acts of Compassion.** Pushed by their Intuitive and Feeling traits, Campaigners try to help others. As social beings, they prefer to make life better for as many people as possible, sometimes all at once.
- **Opportunities in Large Causes.** Large-scale causes create perfect opportunities for these individuals to connect with others. There, they can practice their compassion with and toward many and thrive without having to involve themselves so much with organizing.
- **Deep, Even Spiritual Connections.** Campaigners tend to go deep when forming ties with others. They find their purpose and energy in helping people, and their intense, caring interest can be unique and valued by others. This combination often creates fertile soil for growing special bonds.

Wherever they can help make the lives of others better, these types can fulfill their sense of worth. But this impulse comes from somewhere personal within Campaigners, and it's more meaningful to them if it's about connections. They may have enthusiasm for remote causes in distant places. Their growth, however, comes from the personal touch they add to their altruism by building relationships.

Genuine Interest in Others

Campaigners love discovering what makes people tick, and they zoom past small talk in search of deeper, more personal conversations. When others offer new, interesting ideas and angles, their eyes typically light up. They crave knowing what people believe. From there, Campaigners easily find ways to contribute to their lives:

- **Caring Advisors.** Campaigners' open-mindedness and interest in others give them what they need to be excellent counselors and advisers. They can be skilled at helping those who struggle in life.

- **Boosting Others.** These types inspire those around them with ease, and their caring interest in others is usually encouraging all by itself. Layer passion, openness, and wisdom on top, and their support skills multiply.
- **Abundant Energy.** Campaigners recharge and become strengthened by the good they do. Providing a helping hand energizes them physically, mentally, and emotionally, and it further fosters positive self-respect in them. A healthy sense of one's own worth is also a great potential source of energy.

Campaigners not only show interest in others but, with their tendency toward altruism, they typically find ways to help. This grows their self-respect in positive directions.

Unbalanced Self-Respect

Missing the Mark

While Campaigners are usually dead-on when considering other people's natures, they can form blind spots if they're trying too hard. Yes, they're understanding and Intuitive. But they can take their personal thoughts about the motivations and behaviors of others too far:

- **Do No Harm.** A flash of intuition alone is often not enough. Since theirs is so strong, Campaigners may, on occasion, come to rely on such flashes without checking them against more concrete measures. When this leads to inaccurate responses, others can be hurt, and that consequence is likely to cause damage to Campaigners' self-respect.
- **Too Real.** Being "real" is important to Campaigners. They strive for authenticity, and this may lead them away from their customary diplomatic ways toward something closer to bluntness. But sometimes the people they want to help may not be ready for raw truth.

Because of their easygoing manner, people often expect Campaigners to agree with their beliefs instead of giving honest advice or criticism. If people with this type miss the mark with their intuitive assumptions, others may see them as unreliable. Or, perhaps worse, they could view themselves that way. This might cause them to withdraw and

lose connection with the basis of their self-respect – compassionate ties with people. What they may have thought would build their self-respect may, in the end, separate them from its source.

The Problem with Sainthood

Sainthood has its attractions for these types but reaching for the heights of altruistic excellence is exhausting – and risky. All humans have only limited energy, and life needs balance. However, since compassion so affects Campaigners' sense of worth, they may take their good-heartedness to extremes if they feel they must prove they have value.

When this happens, there could be consequences, including:

- **Burnout.** Taking on other people's problems as their own can drain Campaigners. Mental, emotional, physical, or material sacrifice can limit how much Campaigners can help others.
- **Loss of Control.** They can take on too many ways of supporting others, straining their ability to keep things straight and meet their goals. By trying to help everyone with everything, they may end up accomplishing little.

Because their ideals are linked so tightly with their self-worth, Campaigners may respond in a panic of good works if their self-respect feels less than positive. They might try to make up the difference by going into overdrive. However, if they're not careful, they can end up doing damage to themselves or others. The answer to poor self-respect is likely not martyrdom.

Rebalancing Self-Respect

Linking the Heart and Mind

While Campaigners lead with their feelings, it's essential they learn to expand their comfort zones by applying common sense and reason. This is especially true when they are dealing with others. Most would agree that there's not enough empathy in the world and their intuitive flashes based on their feelings can be valuable in combating this issue. However, there's a place in the middle that honors more balanced impulses. Adopting or developing logic-based strategies for their

kindhearted interests can help Campaigners stay on a reasonable and workable course.

While these types are prone to giving honest counsel, they must also be strategic if they hope to help. Learning to blend their authenticity and intuition with diplomacy and respect for concrete facts can provide them with balance and preserve healthy connections. Remember, those connections feed their self-respect.

A reasoned approach can help prevent the misunderstandings and difficulties that occur when Campaigners go with their assumptions. Learning to balance instinct with taking the time to get hard facts takes practice and patience. But doing so can create more respectful relationships. It may also help all involved trust Campaigners' wisdom more.

Those in need of balancing their self-respect might want to map out objective truths and a more strategic way of talking about them and put it all together. Here's an exercise that might help:

- Divide a piece of paper into three columns. Label them "Truth," "Avoidance," and "Diplomacy."
- Describe some difficult "truth" and put it in the first column. The "truth" should avoid any speculation or "feelings." Instead, it should include only that which can be proven in concrete ways.
- In the second column, describe different ways to avoid dealing with the "truth." Even make it fun or ridiculous.
- In the third column, write five diplomatic things to say while dealing directly with the "truth" in the first column. Reframe the "truth" so that it remains honest yet is easier to swallow. For example, a fellow worker often forgets to follow practical protocol: "You're a very creative person. But sometimes, your great imagination has you skimming over some practical things that need to be considered. You are likely to get more mileage out of your creativity if you can also show how your ideas can work on a practical level and within the system."

Practice the exercise until it becomes second nature. Then, consider combining the first ("Truth") and the third ("Diplomacy") whenever delivering opinions or insights.

The Art of Improving Self-Care

People with the Campaigner personality type can maintain their energy and ability to do good if they understand that they can both take and give in a balanced way. A clear cure for burnout from excessive self-sacrifice is intentional self-care.

Campaigners who balance their altruism with managing their own health and well-being can grow into being even more effective. As a bonus, such balance often brings happiness. Self-care means occasionally topping one's list of priorities with one's own needs. Finding time to tend to the body, mind, and soul is important for everyone, but especially for Campaigners, in danger as they often are of draining themselves through their generosity.

Self-care means getting enough sleep, eating well, working on personal relationships, exercising, and having fun. Campaigners can use the following exercise to start with fun.

- Take a deep breath. (Breathing is always a great way to start self-care.)
- Think back to some recreational activity from the past – something that hasn't been done in the last five or more years. It should be something fun, not something that was abandoned because it grew to be routine or unpleasant in any way.
- Make a date to revisit the chosen carefree pastime of yesteryear. Invite someone else if so inclined.
- Try letting the fun set the tone for a while after the activity. Use the memory to lighten up when things get heavy.

Example: Perhaps a stressed-out Campaigner hasn't gone bowling, sung karaoke, skied on water, or sat through a movie in a theater in the middle of the day for a while. Today might be a great day for any of those. Haven't read a comic book since high school? It might be fun now. Baking a pan

of brownies and binging on a TV show can be an incredible de-stressor. Maybe it's something as simple as cranking up the music and dancing around the house. Life's too short not to punctuate it with plenty of fun. If this time isn't right – that's why calendars are made.

Enjoyment is just the beginning, though. It's vital for Campaigners to find time for themselves, even if that calls for adding plenty of "me time" to their calendars. Eating, sleeping, loving, living, and having fun aren't only essential to a healthy life – eventually, they can also contribute to a productive one.

Self-Confidence

Self-confidence is the internal push that gives people emotional energy. That push moves them forward. Campaigners are self-confident when they're sure they're on the right side of the truth. They're strongest when they feel their behaviors and attitudes match their beliefs.

Balanced Self-Confidence

Connected to Their True Selves

Campaigners' confidence comes from feeling connected to their true selves. They hate anything they regard as phony, and always strive to be as "real" as possible. In their minds, when they see that happening, they have no problem green-lighting the directions they want to pursue.

Campaigners are:

- **Motivated by Basic Character.** Outward details may change, but Campaigners' self-confidence doesn't come from circumstances. It comes from their honest wish to match their actions with their values, and they can still feel confident even if they don't always get the results they want. It's all about character and principles.
- **Flexible.** Open-minded and flexible in their thinking, Campaigners open themselves to alternatives and course corrections. Part of being genuine might involve changing one's mind when evidence demands it, and this helps them avoid the trap of rigidity.

These types develop confidence by aligning with their basic character. That character informs the details of their lives, not the other way around, as it for some types. Their self-confidence comes from staying on the steady course determined by what they believe.

Socially Authentic

While being with people is another energy source for Campaigners, they aren't willing to join with others at any cost. They are at their strongest when they know their social lives match their principles. Knowing they are being consistent when in social settings offers them a sense of self-assurance.

Socially speaking, Campaigners are likely to have:

- **Integrity.** Confident Campaigners are people of integrity. Their values are likely to reflect what they consider best for others, and they build their social self-confidence while they also fill their essential need to do good.
- **Priorities.** Even the Campaigners strongest interests don't determine who they'll join with if the person or group doesn't match their ethical standards. Interests will always come second to values for confident Campaigners.

So much of what motivates Campaigners comes from their need to be true to themselves and the values they hold. Socially, things are no different. Being genuine in social settings gives them more of what they need to move through life more boldly.

Unbalanced Self-Confidence

Identity Confusion

For Campaigners to be true to themselves, they first need to have a clear picture of what that means. If that picture is inaccurate or unclear, then there's likely to be a blow to their self-confidence. Some realistic clarity about one's self is essential. A sense of doubt about who they are and what they stand for can cause them to succumb to the opposite of confidence – perhaps an "identity panic."

Some things that might be responsible for such a crisis include:

- **Unrealistic Expectations.** The Campaigners' unrealistic perfectionism born of idealism might provide them a faulty measure. They might set a standard for how they must behave in the world that is impossible for them to meet.
- **Lack of Confidence Cycle.** If these types should suspect they hold flawed self-knowledge, they can lose confidence. This can lead to a vicious cycle of self-doubt – and self-fulfilling prophecies. One can't be true to oneself, the source of self-confidence, without having confidence in what that means in the first place.

Whatever the cause, should there be identity confusion, Campaigners can lose the energy called for to carry out the tasks that fulfill them. They may fall into a motivational paralysis. Or, alternately, they may increase their activity, hoping that will help them restore confidence in their self-definition. They may rationalize that if one acts like a good person, one is then a good person inside. However, this reverse approach is likely to be flimsy and hard for these types to maintain. Their confidence comes from connecting to what's within, not without.

Outsider Status

Since their Extraverted natures drive them so vigorously, Campaigners value the energy they get from other people. It defines them as much as anything else. But their values-based attitudes and behaviors – which they need for self-confidence – can put them at odds with the others. Their intensity can come across as quirky and unconventional – perhaps making them outsiders in some circles.

Some ways this may play out include:

- **Competing Versions of Themselves.** The social Campaigner and the quirky Campaigner are both true expressions of this type's personality. But both expressions can sometimes compete. This can create a clash that leads to a crisis of confidence.
- **Making Tough Choices.** Applying white lies or artificial attitudes as a social lubricant is sometimes necessary. Unfortunately, choosing to do this can hurt Campaigners' self-confidence, at least in that setting and for that moment in time.

There may always be social tension when some people are different from the others. These same people may also need to be similar enough to others to create connections. This can be a battle for Campaigners if they hope to build or maintain a self-confidence based on honoring their own truths and, yet, still satisfy their social needs.

Rebalancing Self-Confidence

Remove Doubt by Improving Self-Knowledge

"Know thyself" includes knowing one's weaknesses, and, unsurprisingly, most Campaigners are aware of theirs. Some might say that "weakness" is a loaded word and a matter of perspective – some people are better than others at certain things. No one is good at everything. Exploring their weaknesses can help these types realistically anchor their sense of who they are by improving their self-knowledge.

The acceptance of imperfection can sometimes bring more results than clinging to a misguided need to maintain impossible ideals. Campaigners may picture themselves more clearly when they check their perfectionistic tendencies. The following exercise can be used as a small step toward restoring a clear perspective on perfection:

- Choose an activity that's challenging but not overwhelming. It might involve participating in a sport or artistic activity, doing a small, affordable home repair… anything considered a challenge. (Pay attention to all safety issues and remember that a good challenge is one that's difficult, but not impossible.)
- Engage in the activity knowing that "good enough" is sometimes good enough.
- When finished, assess the activity. Was it perfect? Even if it wasn't, was it a worthy effort? Celebrate any flaws with a good laugh and a gleeful acceptance of one of the things it means to be human.

On the surface, being perfect may sound like the most responsible attitude to take. However, nothing kills a sense of self-confidence faster for Campaigners than thinking perfection is essential for being the people they are meant to be. Being human is just fine.

Own Your Uniqueness

Campaigners may need to learn to walk on the balance beam that separates the more conventional world from their imaginative one. The trick is being true to themselves while honoring their social instincts. Nobody likes to feel like an outcast – especially not Extraverts. However, Campaigners are a rare personality type, and not everyone is likely to understand their unique worldview, either.

Discretion and judgment are valuable qualities. Everyone adapts for social reasons occasionally, it's just a matter of degrees and learning when to measure behavior against decorum or shared sensibilities. This may be something Campaigners must cover while learning their life lessons. Then again, maybe their brand of quirkiness is what the world needs.

This can be helpful for Campaigners in taking the first step toward discovering and owning their uniqueness:

- List five things that make you different from most people you know.
- Choose one of them and find some way to highlight it. For example, a left-handed person might playfully refuse to use their right hand for a meal. They may keep their right hand in their lap. They may explain it as a quirky experiment.
- Keep it light and fun.
- Note the reactions of those involved. Are they critical? Who is laughing along with the experiment? Who is rolling their eyes benignly? Are there any bad reactions?

Most will find that their unique quality is perfectly acceptable to others and something worth treasuring in themselves. People who stand out for whatever reason learn that accepting themselves is a necessary element for having a fulfilling life. Campaigners who revel in their uniqueness are likely to be happier than those who are self-conscious. If they're true to themselves, they boost their confidence and are comfortable in their own skins. Such confidence should make the reveling easier.

Self-Evolution

The term "self-evolution" describes a more purposeful effort of developing oneself. This involves tactics and strategies for building one's self-esteem, self-confidence, and self-respect needs. Campaigners not only enjoy the process, but find meaning in the process itself, and see it as carrying the same importance as the results.

Balanced Self-Evolution

Constant Self-Improvement

Campaigners, as with most Diplomats, are interested in ongoing self-improvement. Their primary focus includes developing their values, goals, and purposes. Campaigners who address this process, and most do, typically stick to their core values, use their strengths and counter their weaknesses, and take on their life goals.

Typically, Campaigners:

- **Define Life as "Growth."** Campaigners define life as growth, and to achieve satisfaction, they must have some sense that growth is constantly occurring. Self-evolution is hardly a hobby or something extra in their lives.
- **Plan Their Own Course.** Campaigners plan their self-evolution through ambition (no matter how benign) and deliberate experiences. Like everyone else, they may grow through some of the things that happen to them, but that alone is never enough. They usually are very active in plotting their growth through planning, training, and acting.

Campaigners rarely allow themselves to feel like they've stagnated. They generally do something to spur their growth before that happens.

Self-Development and the Community

As personal and sometimes introspective as self-evolution can be, Campaigners intentionally include other people. Since they define themselves through their social context, growth outside of other people's company is difficult for these types.

Campaigners usually choose to:

- **Grow Within a Community.** While some may go off to quiet places to find themselves, Campaigners are likely to look for themselves in the din of the crowd. They involve the people around them when they grow. They tailor their self-improvement plans around their interactions with their communities.
- **Be Individuals in a Crowd.** Campaigners never stop being individuals with unique ways of expressing themselves. But they must share their individuality for it to mean much to them. It makes sense that they become who they're going to be within their natural habitat, the social arena.

People are a part of everything Campaigners value. It's no surprise that the same is true for their self-evolution. Their energy comes from their involvement in their community, and it takes real energy to purposely grow.

Unbalanced Self-Evolution

Lack of Focus

Campaigners can struggle with a lack of focus when they're unable to align their passions or pursuits with their personal values and goals. There's always so much personal growth they want to accomplish that it may be hard to concentrate on just one thing.

Some of the areas where this is most obvious include:

- **Difficulty Committing.** This personality type is famous for exploring a wide range of possibilities. This approach helps when they're forming ideas. But it offers little when they need to make commitments, and without some level of commitment, planned personal development is impossible.
- **Unclear Direction.** Campaigners often go with the flow, making no effort to control their desires and ideas. But those who can't nail down a clear direction may have difficulty finding a path that leads to growth.

Part of their self-evolution may include learning to define a clear target for growth and committing to it. Otherwise, their goals may remain too vague to be useful.

Overlooking Details

Campaigners often pay attention to the big ideas while neglecting smaller details. This can interfere with any strategies or plans for self-development, and ignoring small steps can make the larger steps harder.

Sometimes, Campaigners' self-evolution is plagued with the following:

- **Missing the Details.** A great and noble project can fail if no one checks the legal details, handles administrative tasks, or manages the workload. The same principle can apply to the personal lives of Campaigners who fail to make grocery shopping lists or pay the bills. Such details, if ignored, can disrupt the path toward intentional personal growth.
- **Off-track.** Campaigners need to manage their tendency to be distracted. These types must make sure that their minds always stay on track, especially if a phase of the process is relatively dull.

Self-improvement can easily become a struggle if Campaigners neglect details critical to success. They must also be willing to endure the less-than-exciting parts that are inevitable parts of any self-growth. Self-evolution depends on strategies. And successful strategies depend on attention to detail – even sometimes boring details.

Rebalancing Self-Evolution

Improve Your Self-Control for Better Focus

While adaptability is a great strength that many Campaigners share, it has its downside. Being so willing to adapt that they fail to develop the ability to focus is a struggle than many individuals with this personality type face. To overcome this distractibility, Campaigners need to improve and enhance their self-control. They must learn to harness this self-control to overcome distraction, whether it comes from sources outside of themselves or from within their minds.

Almost paradoxically, building plenty of time into the day to let the mind wander can help them be more attentive when it's needed. Some of the greatest insights in human history came from wandering minds. Knowing when to let the mind drift and when to focus are important parts of fostering results in life. Purposely taking "dream" breaks can clear the head for greater focus later. Developing both the ability to think creatively and to make detailed plans from those creative ideas are likely to aid Campaigners' self-evolution.

A good exercise to explore the balance between a productive wandering mind and productive focus involves brainstorming and goal-setting. These are two steps in the same process. To try this, Campaigners can follow these steps to plan their next day off in the following fashion:

- Write down at least 15 things that can be done with the free hours ahead. Don't worry about how plausible they are at this stage, so long as they are at least close to realistic. Fifteen is a lot, but brainstorming is all about pushing the limits of the imagination.
- From the 15, pick three that can be done during the next few hours. Choose by any preferred criteria: urgently needed, enjoyable activity, will make a friend or partner happy, etc.
- Break each of the three down three ways: What is needed to accomplish the activity? What steps need to be taken? What will it look like when the activity is successfully completed – how will that be measured?
- Gather the supplies, manpower, or whatever is needed. Work through the steps. Measure the results.

Campaigners who explore this exercise may experience two things:

- An opportunity to enjoy their native imaginative and creative side.
- The opportunity to develop a detailed plan and see it through.

The more these types adopt this rhythm, the more likely they are to keep their balance when working through their self-evolution.

Improve Creativity with Organization

Solutions to problems often need to be specific. Campaigners interested in personal growth may know they need to make detailed plans. But they sometimes see an organized approach as getting in the way of their creativity and imagination.

Rather than thinking of organized rationality as the opposite of the way Campaigners think, it can be more useful to think of strategic ideas as ways of extending their imaginations. Why squander a strength they can use? Instead of trying to change how they think to make them more like other types, widening the scope of their imaginations may be the key.

Here are exercises that can be used for expanding imaginative thinking in more concrete ways.

- First, imagine each of these scenarios deeply and completely. Closing the eyes may help. Respond to these four scenarios in as imaginatively practical and detailed terms as possible. There's no right answer. Have fun with them.
    - You're on a beach. A tidal wave is visible on the horizon to the south. To the north is a sheer cliff that extends for more than a mile in each direction. How do you escape? You have only minutes to decide.
    - A time traveler from the future appears and seems to know a lot about you. He can't give you advice or directions, but he can tell you one predetermined fact about your life that can lead you on a path to an outstanding future. But he can't tell you without your asking about it. It's a time traveler noninterference thing. It's got to be just one fact. No opinions. No impressions. No advice. Just a concrete fact. How do you decide what to ask about?
    - List five ways you can affect the world by simply getting up tomorrow.
    - Think of three ways that the smartphone could bring about world peace.

These are difficult scenarios. A couple of them border on impossible, and clearly don't provide enough information. Yet critical and strategic

thinking aren't just about learning a technique that magically connects all the dots and leads to one right solution. Such methods are unlikely to work with Campaigners anyway. For them, critical thinking is about expanding what they already own – their imaginations – to construct practical, specific solutions.

Self-Responsibility

Self-responsibility is Campaigners' ability to take charge of their decisions and results without depending on others or accepting all that happens as fate. When they assign their actions honestly, they can take credit and blame with integrity. They know what they can control and what they can't.

Balanced Self-Responsibility

Independent, but Not Alone

Self-responsibility, or being responsible, sounds simple. Still, many people must work hard to develop this trait. Campaigners gain greater amounts of self-responsibility by acting independently, taking proper credit or blame, and keeping their own counsel.

For Campaigners, this generally means:

- **Acting on Values.** Campaigners who are responsible act on their principles without feeling guilty or trying to discover what others think. They follow their own consciences rather than the opinions of others.
- **Fine with the Like-Minded.** That said, Campaigners would rather not isolate themselves. These types can happily go with the consensus of groups as long as they honor the Campaigners' ethics. But part of Campaigners' self-responsibility is seeing how far they can go with others and still uphold their own principles.

When their sense of responsibility is well formed, Campaigners know they alone are responsible for their actions and attitudes. That, however, doesn't stop them from joining with like-minded others.

Proactive

Campaigners who practice self-responsibility know their core values. They use them to achieve their personal goals. Self-responsibility goes beyond self-understanding, however – it means fulfilling their hopes and being accountable for what they do, both good and bad.

For this to happen, they must take:

- **An Active Moral Role.** For Campaigners to fulfill their other growth needs, it's essential they take an active role in expressing their values and ideals. In this arena, they typically ask, "If not me, then who?"
- **A Supporting Role.** Campaigners see loyalty to others as a moral issue and are likely to proactively do anything they consider an obligation. These types think it unacceptable to let themselves and other people down. So, they often step up to support the needs of others.

It's not responsible to allow priorities to slide. It's also not responsible to wander aimlessly through life ignoring personally important issues. Responsible Campaigners find themselves attending to the things they think important.

Unbalanced Self-Responsibility

Independence Lost

No matter what the personality type, self-responsibility needs some measure of independence; it's almost part of the definition. When Campaigners cling to their values, they're likely to take responsibility for living them independent of the view of other people.

However, problems arise when:

- **Independence Meets Social Expectations.** The social parts of Campaigners' lives are also important, and there lies the potential for conflict. Should their convictions run counter to the opinions of those they care about, hard choices can be necessary. These choices can be weighty for these sensitive, social types.

- **Campaigners in a Weakened State.** Those Campaigners who question their own value and confidence might rely on another source of energy and approval: other people. During these times, the urging of the crowd is more persuasive than the call of the conscience.

A conflict between their principles and their social needs can crumble their sense of responsibility and have them acting to please others. This is likely to damage their overall personal growth.

Becoming Helpless

With all the effort they put in, the disconnect Campaigners experience between their aspirations and their accomplishments can feel like failure. They can acquire a sense that no matter what they do, they never gain traction. "Why bother?" may be their conclusion.

This happens because:

- **High Expectations.** Since Campaigners are so idealistic, their failures may not even be considered real by others who aren't so hard on themselves. Instead, they may be examples of the imperfection and limitations common to all people. However, Campaigners may allow their high-minded principles to twist their views of their accomplishments.
- **Lose the Feeling of Control.** These frustrations can strip Campaigners of their sense of control. Without a feeling of control, it's reasonable for them to conclude they also hold no responsibility.

If these types believe they have no control, and nothing changes, they might conclude there's no point in trying to do anything. Because of the moral overtones of their lives and their sensitivity, such handing over of responsibility may cause a moral crisis for them. They may think of themselves as not just helpless people, they may see themselves as bad helpless people. Before long, more damaging negative self-talk can gain a foothold.

Rebalancing Self-Responsibility

How to Form a Consensus

Sometimes, Campaigners, in the name of their ideals, stubbornly stand up to others. This can cause friction, especially if the ideals are not accepted by those they are standing up to – much less practiced by them. On the other hand, in the name of wanting to be part of a group, Campaigners might cave in to the demands and opinions of others to fit in. Putting other people's opinions and attitudes in charge may be the opposite of being responsible for oneself.

Sometimes, however, there's a third choice between boldly opposing others and giving in to them. This choice involves compromise and building a consensus. When people are given a difficult choice, there are often ways to please everyone without surrendering what is important. It may be possible that Campaigners can act responsibly while giving others what they want.

Here are steps Campaigners can take toward forming this consensus:

- First, determine how decisions will be made. Will there be a single individual, a group vote, or even drawing the choice out of a hat filled with acceptable choices? Laying this groundwork initially is important.
- Clearly define what is being decided. Be specific.
- Develop the list of potential choices, their implications, and their consequences. Campaigners are likely to want a discussion of values in this step. Discuss the aspects that are acceptable and unacceptable.
- After each case is made, turn the topic over to the chosen decision-making method.
- There's always a potential stalemate in any negotiation. Consider an arbiter or facilitator to help resolve it.

While this is a formal method of building a consensus and finding compromise, Campaigners can apply the same principles informally. The important point to remember is that, when they disagree with someone, it's not always a binary choice between "this way" and "that way." Sometimes there's a third way, and everybody is pleased.

From Helpless to Helpful

Giving up personal responsibility because of a sense of helplessness can only be resolved by regaining a sense of effectiveness, and the most obvious way to beat helplessness is to succeed. There are many ways in life to set individuals up for success. But the most common way combines a clear intent and an action plan.

Forming an intent can come easily to Campaigners, and developing an action plan is a skill they can gain with a little effort. While they learn, it may help if they partner with someone who has developed action plans already or has a natural knack for getting things done. Such people are likely to be in their vast network of friends, family, and acquaintances. One of the best ways to learn is by doing. Such partnerships are likely to encourage participation and lead to picking up helpful habits.

The following exercise can help and will require some thought, a little planning, and a measure of action.

Set a two-minute timer. Think of the nicest thing you can do for a specific person. Stick to the timer and don't overthink it. At the end of two minutes, there should be a specific person and a specific nice thing to do for them.

- Set a 10-minute timer and list these things:
  - What date and time will the nice thing be accomplished?
  - What actions need to be taken to do the nice thing? By what date and time will the actions be completed?
  - What resources will be needed, if any? By what date and time will the resources be gathered?
- Follow the dictum, "Plan your work, and work your plan." When the plan has been accomplished, celebrate by doing something nice for yourself.
- Repeat this exercise once a week for a month, or more if it resonates.

Campaigners who are discouraged might find that even the smallest success lessens a sense of helplessness. And small successes typically lead to larger ones. Getting help from someone who is good at organizing and motivating others is helpful. Ultimately, however, success comes through planning and action.

Final Words

The Adaptive Self

Campaigners are unique, open people who are most at home around others. Those who leverage their strengths while expanding their comfort zone can discover personal growth. It's basically a balance of being true to themselves while adapting to the world around them. And adapt they must, if they're to keep social connections strong. The balance is in not adapting so much that they lose their sense of self.

Campaigners all have their own spin on life, having adapted to their unique circumstances as individuals. Some skillfully navigate personal growth most of the time and others, some of the time. Still others may struggle. Like all people, Campaigners waver between those days filled with wonderful growth and those that lack, or even undo, such experiences. No Campaigner goes through life in any perfect way, but growth and learning are always choices for those who are willing. Hopefully, this book has provided guidance or inspiration to bolster that willingness.

Warmhearted Connection

For Campaigners, living to the fullest means bonding deeply with others. People with this personality type aim to spot the potential and goodness in everyone who crosses paths with them, and they gain energy and inspiration from their interactions with other people. In a world that's all too often frozen in convention and judgment, Campaigners' warmth and positivity are gifts.

This doesn't mean that Campaigners don't have their share of challenges. For them, the greatest moments of personal growth often arise when they face difficulties and blind spots. Fortunately, these personalities have the creativity and energy to find routes through such challenges. And because of their gregarious, generous nature, they often have many people in their lives who are happy to lend a hand – or a fresh perspective.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you direct your personal growth journey? Explore our Personal Growth Specialized Tests.
- Looking to enhance your academic or professional life? Check out the *Campaigner Guide to Careers*.
- Feeling adrift when it comes to your romantic relationships, friendships, or relationships with your children? Our *Campaigner Guide to Relationships* may be just what you need.

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